

ISO 14001

An environmental management system released by the International Organisation for Standardization

2005

According to NASA, 2005 was the warmest year since the availability of reliable measurement systems

The green channel...

We contacted companies to get a feel of their contribution to the environment. This is just a snapshot. We initiated dialogue with many more, but very few responded. Some companies were eager and proactive in talking about their green initiatives. Others, despite bragging about their achievements, shied away from responding. The following were the responses we received.

HCL Infosystems Limited

What's HCL's stand on going green?

How high on your agenda is it?

The duty of protecting and preserving the environment has to be shouldered by one and all. HCL Infosystems takes pride in being the first Indian company to have ISO 14001 certification in manufacturing and also RoHS compliance in our complete range of desktops and notebooks.

Does HCL use renewable power?

Yes, we use renewable energy sources like solar energy. This year, we plan to double the amount of renewable energy as compared to last year.

What are the most significant changes HCL has made over the past year to go green? What are your future plans in the same direction?

We use Spot Air Conditioning in our manufacturing unit. This approach to cooling concentrates the cool air at heat generating points/areas only, hence reducing energy consumption.

Is it cheaper or more expensive (in the long run)?

Consumers as citizens of the earth are sensitive to environment and we are already seeing a shift in attitude of the consumers when buying. Going forward in the long run green products will have an advantage as far as sustainable value-for-money is concerned. From a long-term perspective, going Green makes our systems more efficient and sustainable, hence offsetting the initial cost.

Do you have any special drives to encourage your customers to go green and recycle your products?

HCL Infosystems initiated 'Green Bag' campaign where people come and discard their old IT equipment like computers, keyboard and printers in an environment-



George Paul, Executive Vice President, HCL Infosystems Limited, 6400 employees globally

friendly way through all the HCL Touch centres. HCL Infosystems has also set up an eWaste helpdesk to support computer owners with help/resolution of any problem faced during disposal process by sending an email to ewaste.safe@hcl.in.

Have you made changes to your products as part of your green initiative?

We recently have launched PVC-free laptop in the market. The eco-friendly ME notebook has been designed and manufactured with materials completely free of harmful chemicals like Polyvinyl Chloride (PVC), a hazardous toxin, absence of which makes recycling of electronic products safer and environment friendly. Elimination of PVC would bring down exposure of poisonous chemicals reducing risks to health and environment. Also, our products comply to the latest Energy Star 5.0 specifications.

Gigabyte

Rajan Sharma, GM, Sales and Marketing, Global employees: 3000+ (45+ in India)

What's Gigabyte's stand on going green? How high on your agenda is it?

Going green is an endeavour on which we had our eyes set right from 2006-07 RoHS

compliance agreements. We strive towards ensuring that our customers get green and affordable technology and meet the broader goal of protecting the environment.

Does Gigabyte use renewable power?

Yes, we use renewable power in our manufacturing plants and factories.

What are the most significant changes Gigabyte has made over the past year to go green? What are your future plans in the same direction?

We have launched green and energy efficient motherboards with EES & DES technologies to help desktops consume less power. GIGABYTE has made a concerted effort to produce motherboards that use the least amount of energy possible without sacrificing performance.

Is it cheaper or more expensive (in the long run)?

Adoption of green technology will definitely help in the long run. With the rising cost of energy and its increased consumption at every level, conservation and optimization strategies are increasingly important to overall profitability. For example, the amount of power which customers can save due to our G41/H55/P55 motherboards is almost equal to cost of the product, used over 3-4 years life-cycle.

What were your 2009-2010 spends towards this, and is the allocated 2010-2011 budget higher or lower?

Our R&D is constantly working towards maximizing goals and conserving and designing products that help make green technology effective.

Do you do anything special to get customers to recycle?

Yes, we work closely with like-minded companies to achieve this objective.